



Learning Modalities in SMIT: Student Preferences For Face-to-Face, Online, Hybrid, or Blended

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CHAPTER I. THE PROBLEM AND ITS BACKGROUND

Introduction

The COVID-19 pandemic brought about an unprecedented shift in education, necessitating the rapid adoption of online learning as schools and universities worldwide adjusted to health and safety restrictions. This shift presented both challenges and opportunities. While online learning allowed for flexibility and continuity during the pandemic, it also highlighted issues related to resource access and student engagement. Today, schools including De La Salle-College of Saint Benilde, are transitioning back to full face-to-face learning while employing blended and hybrid learning models as a midpoint transition.

However, this transition is not without challenges. In urban environments like the campus of De La Salle-College of Saint Benilde in Metro Manila, students encounter logistical barriers such as heavy traffic, limited parking spaces, overcrowded campuses, and long lines for public transportation. These issues, exacerbated by infrastructural constraints, can potentially affect the overall academic experience of students.

This study seeks to investigate the preferred learning modalities of the School of Management and Information Technology (SMIT) students in light of the ongoing logistical and academic challenges they face. Understanding their preferences for different learning formats (Full Face-to-Face, Online, Hybrid, or Blended) will be essential in determining how best to support their educational needs.

Background of the Study

In the post-pandemic era, educational institutions, including De La Salle-College of Saint Benilde, have been navigating the complexities of integrating various learning modalities such as face-to-face, online, hybrid, and blended formats. Among these, hybrid and blended models, which combine in-person classes with online components, have gained significant traction. These approaches are particularly valued for their potential to address diverse student needs by balancing engagement with accessibility.

In urban environments like Metro Manila, these learning modalities are further complicated by infrastructural challenges, which significantly impact students' daily routines. Metro Manila is notorious for heavy traffic congestion, long commute times, limited parking spaces, and overcrowded facilities. These challenges lead to fatigue, reduced productivity, and compromised academic performance. For instance, a study focusing on senior high school students found that traffic congestion adversely affects their punctuality and readiness for classes, which in turn had adverse effects on academic outcomes (Cadaoas, 2019). This issue is particularly relevant to commuter students who struggle to balance their studies with the demands of their daily commute.

Research has shown that commuting is not only a logistical challenge but also a significant factor affecting student well-being and academic performance. A study on undergraduate commuter students highlighted how commuting adds stress, reduces study time, and limits participation in extracurricular activities, all which can negatively impact academic success (He, 2019). Another study from Kingston University London found that longer commute times were linked to lower student satisfaction with their timetables, particularly among

commuter students from ethnic minority backgrounds (Page et al., 2021). These findings emphasize the need for learning models that account for the strain commuting places on students, especially in metropolitan areas like Metro Manila.

The preferences of students regarding learning modalities are shaped by logical and academic factors, which vary across demographics and programs. For example, a study on JCU Singapore's hybrid Master of Guidance and Counselling programs highlighted students' appreciation for flexibility of online learning, although it also emphasized the need for self-regulation and motivation (Carter, 2013). Similarly, students in the Philippines during the COVID-19 pandemic faced challenges like poor internet connectivity and limited access to suitable study spaces, underscoring the importance of effective online teaching methods and faculty training (Fabito et al., 2020).

Further research has also shown that students tend to prefer diverse instructional methods, such as live discussions and small group chats. However, the effectiveness of these methods often depended on the experience and communication of the instructors (Gills & Krull, 2020). In addition, a study at the Lucerne School of Business revealed that students' preferences for online learning were influenced by factors such as location and workload. Students who were located outside the area or had heavier workloads were more likely to lean toward online learning (Feubli et al., 2023).

Despite the increasing adoption of hybrid and blended learning models, there is limited research examining the specific logistical challenges of highly urbanized environments, like Metro Manila, influencing students' preferences. Most existing studies often overlook the unique infrastructural difficulties in such settings, creating a gap in the literature. This study aims to

address that gap by exploring the interplay between logistical barriers and learning modality preferences among SMIT students. The findings will offer valuable insights to help design flexible and effective learning environments that align with the realities students face in urban areas.

Statement of the Problem

Despite the growing adoption of online and hybrid learning models, there is limited research specifically focusing on how these challenges influence students' learning modality preferences at SMIT. While there have been studies on student preferences in general, they often do not address the unique context of Manila's urban environment and the specific difficulties students encounter. This gap in the literature makes it difficult for institutions to effectively tailor their educational offerings to meet students' evolving needs.

This research aims to fill this gap by providing data-driven insights into SMIT students' preferred learning modalities. By gathering and analyzing their preferences, this study will help the university make informed decisions about the future structure of its classes, ensuring that educational delivery is aligned with students' needs and the realities of their daily lives.

Objectives of the Study

The main research question of this study is:

How do SMIT students' preferences for learning modalities relate to their academic experiences and logistical challenges?

To address this, the study aims to explore these underlying questions:

1. What are the preferred learning modalities (Full Face-to-Face, Online, Hybrid, or Blended) among SMIT students at De La Salle-College of Saint Benilde?
2. What key factors influence students' preferences for each learning modality?
3. How do logistical challenges such as limited parking, overcrowded campuses, and traffic congestion affect students' choices of learning modalities?
4. How do preferences differ across various student demographics?

The goal of this study is to understand the factors shaping SMIT students' preferences for learning modalities. This includes analyzing how logistical and academic challenges influence these preferences and identifying differences across demographics. By doing so, the study aims to provide insights that can help the school develop strategies to optimize the learning environment and address existing challenges effectively.

Hypothesis

Null Hypothesis (H_0):

There is no significant relationship between the logistical and academic challenges faced by SMIT students and their preferences for learning modalities (Full Face-to-Face, Online, Hybrid, or Blended)

Alternative Hypothesis (H_A):

SMIT students' preferences for learning modalities are significantly influenced by logistical challenges (e.g., parking, traffic congestion, overcrowded campuses) and demographic factors (e.g., year level, degree program), with logistical challenges playing a primary role.

CHAPTER II. METHODOLOGY

This study will adopt a quantitative research approach to explore SMIT students' preferences for learning modalities at De La Salle-College of Saint Benilde. The data will be collected through an online questionnaire to ensure accessibility and maximize participation across the student population. The survey will include a combination of multiple-choice questions, Likert scale items (to assess preferences), and open-ended questions (to capture additional insights and comments). The questions will focus on students' preferred learning modalities (Full Face-to-Face, Online, Hybrid, or Blended), factors that influence these preferences, and challenges encountered with each modality. The survey will also gather demographic information to analyze differences in preferences based on factors such as year level and academic program.

Convenience sampling will be employed to gather respondents and their responses will be analyzed using descriptive statistics to identify the most preferred learning modalities and the key factors that influence these preferences. Cross-tabulation will be used to examine how preferences differ across various demographic groups, such as year level and program.

This methodological approach ensures that the research is rigorous and that the findings will be based on a comprehensive and representative sample of the student population. The results will provide valuable insights into the learning modality preferences of SMIT students and help inform strategies for optimizing the learning environment at the institution.

Respondents/Participants

The target respondents for this study are SMIT students currently enrolled at De La Salle-College of Saint Benilde, encompassing all year levels and academic programs. The survey seeks to collect a broad range of perspectives from diverse segments of the student body. This diversity will allow for the identification of trends or patterns in learning modality preferences, which may be shaped by factors such as course requirements, commuting distance, and academic workload.

CHAPTER III. RESULTS AND DISCUSSIONS

Research Question:

What are the preferred learning modalities (Full Face-to-Face, Online, Hybrid, or Blended) among SMIT students at De La Salle-College of Saint Benilde?

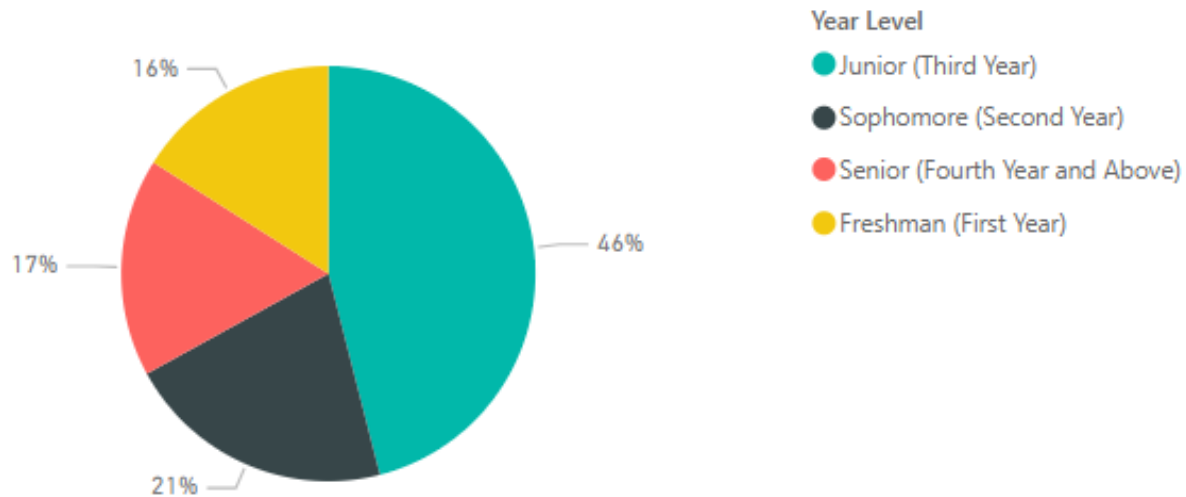


Fig. 1. Pie chart showing the respondent distribution by year level

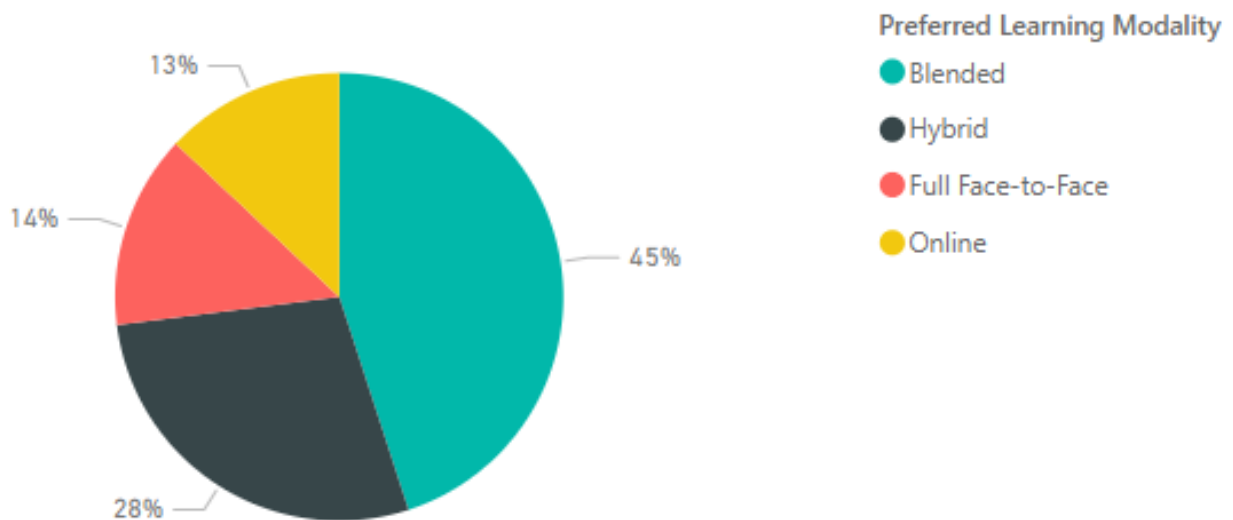


Fig. 2. Pie chart showing the distribution of SMIT students' preferred learning modalities

The pie charts provide an overview of the year levels of SMIT students and their preferences for learning modalities at De La Salle-College of Saint Benilde. Among the respondents, the largest group consists of Junior (Third Year) students, accounting for 46% of the total sample. This is followed by Sophomores (Second Year) at 21% and Seniors (Fourth Year and above) at 17%. Freshmen (First Year) represent the smallest proportion, making up 16% of the respondents. This distribution suggests that the majority of the data reflects the perspectives of upperclassmen, particularly those with more experience in navigating different learning modalities.

In terms of learning modality preferences, blended learning emerges as the most favored option among SMIT students, chosen by 45% of the respondents. Hybrid learning ranks second at 28%, full face-to-face ranks third at 14%, and online learning is the least preferred at 13%. These results indicate a strong preference for modalities that combine online and in-person learning. The results suggest that students desire learning flexibility while retaining some level of interaction and engagement.

The preferences for blended and hybrid modalities may reflect the logistical challenges and academic needs faced by students in Metro Manila, such as traffic congestion and long commutes. Conversely, the lower preference for full face-to-face and online learning may indicate that students seek a balanced approach, avoiding the extremes of fully remote or entirely in-person setups. However, the fact that the majority of responses are from third-year students may mean that their perspectives may be influenced by their greater familiarity and experience with different learning environments compared to underclassmen.

Research Question:

What key factors influence students' preferences for each learning modality?

Multinomial Logistic Regression for Predictors of Preferred Learning Modality

Model Fit Measures

Model	Deviance	AIC	BIC	R ² _{McF}
1	180.63	228.63	291.15	0.28

Model Coefficients - Preferred Learning Modality

Preferred Learning Modality	Predictor	Estimate	SE	Z	p
Blended - Full Face-to-Face	Intercept	3.62	4.73	0.77	0.444
	Commute Time	0.37	0.47	0.79	0.427
	Access to campus resources and facilities	0.47	0.83	0.56	0.577
	Interaction with classmates and faculty	-1.98	1.25	-1.58	0.114
	Flexibility in class schedules	0.75	0.84	0.89	0.371
	Personal convenience	1.83	1.04	1.75	0.079
	Hands-on learning opportunities	-1.32	1.08	-1.23	0.220
	Collaboration with peers	-0.46	1.31	-0.36	0.722
Hybrid - Full Face-to-Face	Intercept	3.72	4.77	0.78	0.435
	Commute Time	0.57	0.48	1.21	0.227
	Access to campus resources and facilities	0.15	0.84	0.18	0.856
	Interaction with classmates and faculty	-1.81	1.26	-1.44	0.150
	Flexibility in class schedules	0.05	0.84	0.06	0.955
	Personal convenience	1.93	1.05	1.83	0.067
	Hands-on learning opportunities	-0.91	1.09	-0.83	0.404
	Collaboration with peers	-0.39	1.31	-0.30	0.764
Online - Full Face-to-Face	Intercept	4.00	5.49	0.73	0.466
	Commute Time	0.64	0.57	1.13	0.257
	Access to campus resources and facilities	0.35	0.93	0.38	0.708
	Interaction with classmates and faculty	-2.21	1.29	-1.71	0.087
	Flexibility in class schedules	-0.45	0.91	-0.49	0.626
	Personal convenience	2.92	1.20	2.44	0.015
	Hands-on learning opportunities	-1.61	1.15	-1.40	0.162
	Collaboration with peers	-0.57	1.37	-0.42	0.674

Fig. 3. Multinomial Logistic Regression for Predictors of Preferred Learning Modality

To answer the research question, we conducted a multinomial logistic regression analysis of factors influencing preferences for learning modalities as seen on Figure 3. Using Full Face-to-Face as a reference category, the results showed a moderate model fit with a

R²McFadden value of 0.28. Personal convenience is highlighted as a key factor influencing the preference for online learning, with a p-value of 0.015. This suggests that students who prioritize personal convenience are significantly more likely to choose online learning compared to face-to-face learning.

Other factors, including commute time, access to campus resources, and interaction with classmates and faculty, did not show statistically significant effects ($p > 0.05$) across all learning modalities. These findings suggest that personal convenience plays a more decisive role in shaping students' preferences for online learning than logistic or academic challenges.

Multinomial Logistic Regression

Model Fit Measures

Model	Deviance	AIC	R ² _{Mcf}
1	231.07	273.07	0.08

Model Coefficients - Preferred Learning Modality

Preferred Learning Modality	Predictor	Estimate	SE	Z	p
Blended - Full Face-to-Face	Intercept	0.01	0.82	0.01	0.994
	Transportation Challenges:				
	High – Low	2.80	1.81	1.55	0.122
	Moderate – Low	-0.85	1.22	-0.70	0.484
	Campus Accessibility Challenges:				
	High – Low	-0.22	0.94	-0.24	0.812
	Moderate – Low	0.97	1.16	0.83	0.404
	Safety Concerns:				
	High – Low	-1.08	1.59	-0.68	0.499
Hybrid - Full Face-to-Face	Moderate – Low	1.72	1.13	1.53	0.126
	Intercept	0.40	0.76	0.53	0.596
	Transportation Challenges:				
	High – Low	0.38	1.80	0.21	0.831
	Moderate – Low	-1.68	1.25	-1.34	0.180
	Campus Accessibility Challenges:				
	High – Low	-0.08	1.00	-0.08	0.936
	Moderate – Low	1.02	1.25	0.82	0.415
	Safety Concerns:				
Online - Full Face-to-Face	High – Low	0.32	1.66	0.19	0.846
	Moderate – Low	1.46	1.20	1.22	0.223
	Intercept	-38.19	0.78	-49.00	< .001
	Transportation Challenges:				
	High – Low	40.52	1.13	35.70	< .001
	Moderate – Low	21.87	0.63	34.58	< .001
	Campus Accessibility Challenges:				
	High – Low	-0.56	1.11	-0.51	0.611
	Moderate – Low	1.94	1.61	1.21	0.227
	Safety Concerns:				
	High – Low	-1.78	1.72	-1.03	0.301
	Moderate – Low	16.06	0.63	25.39	< .001

Fig. 4. Multinomial Logistic Regression for Aggregated Challenges (Transportation, Campus Accessibility, and Safety Concerns) on Preferred Learning Modality

The multinomial logistic regression analysis assessed how aggregated logistical challenges (transportation, campus accessibility, and safety) influence SMIT students'

preferences for learning modalities. The challenges were grouped based on conceptual similarities. Transportation challenges included variables such as long commute times, heavy traffic, and inaccessibility of transportation options. Campus accessibility challenges grouped factors like limited parking space and long lines for the e-jeep. Safety concerns remained a standalone category, given its unique nature and potential distinct impact on modality preferences.

The results revealed that transportation challenges significantly influenced preferences for online learning over full face-to-face learning. Students who reported moderate or high levels of transportation difficulties were much more likely to prefer online learning ($p\text{-value} < 0.001$). This result suggests that commuting difficulties cause students to favor online modality that eliminates the need for physical travel. However, these challenges did not significantly influence preferences for blended or hybrid learning modalities, suggesting that the flexibility of partial face-to-face classes may not sufficiently address transportation-related concerns.

The issue of safety also significantly affected preferences for online learning, with safety concerns rated as “Moderate” increasing the likelihood of choosing online learning ($p\text{-value} < 0.001$). Students who see travelling between campus buildings or the around the surrounding areas as unsafe are more inclined to select learning modalities that minimize their need to go to the campus. However safety concerns also did not significantly influence preferences for blended or hybrid learning.

Campus accessibility challenges, such as limited parking and long lines for the e-jeep did not significantly impact preferences for any learning modality. This result may indicate that these challenges are less critical compared to the broader transportation and safety issues faced by

students. Overall, the findings emphasize that logistical barriers are strong determinants of preferences for online learning. In contrast, blended and hybrid modalities appear to be shaped by other factors, such as interaction preferences or academic requirements.

Research Question:

How do logistical challenges such as limited parking, overcrowded campuses, and traffic congestion affect students' choices of learning modalities?

Contingency Tables

Contingency Tables						
Preferred learning modality	Impact of these challenges towards learning experience					Total
	Not at all	Slightly	Moderately	Very	Extremely	
Blended	0	5	11	23	6	45
Full Face-to-Face	1	7	2	3	1	14
Hybrid	1	5	5	10	7	28
Online	0	1	2	6	4	13
Total	2	18	20	42	18	100

χ^2 Tests			
	Value	df	p
χ^2	20.2	12	0.064
N	100		

Fig. 5. Contingency table and chi square result between the impact of logistical challenges towards preferred learning modality of SMIT students

The contingency table on Figure 5 examines the relationship between students' preferred learning modalities and their perceptions of the impact of logistical challenges on their learning experiences. Respondents rated the extent to which these challenges (e.g., limited parking, overcrowded campuses, and traffic congestion) affected their learning on a Likert scale from 1 (Not at All) to 5 (Extremely).

The chi-square test result ($p = 0.064$) indicates that there is no statistically significant relationship between the preferred learning modality and the perceived impact of these challenges at the 95% confidence level. However, the p-value is close to the significance threshold, suggesting that there may be a weak or marginal association worth further exploration.

From the distribution of responses, students preferring blended and hybrid learning modalities were most likely to report that logistical challenges had a "Moderate" to "Extremely" significant impact on their learning experiences. In contrast, those preferring full face-to-face learning tended to report a "Slight" or "Moderate" impact. These findings suggest that while logistical challenges may influence students' learning experiences across modalities, students in more flexible modalities like blended or hybrid learning may feel these challenges more acutely, possibly due to their reliance on balancing online and in-person components.

Research Question:

How do preferences differ across various student demographics?

Contingency Tables

Contingency Tables

Preferred learning modality	Degree Program		Total
	SMIT-ACI	SMIT-LME	
Blended	29	16	45
Full Face-to-Face	0	14	14
Hybrid	20	8	28
Online	12	1	13
Total	61	39	100

χ^2 Tests

	Value	df	p
χ^2	28.8	3	<.001
N	100		

Fig. 6. Chi square computation between the preferred learning modality of ACI and LME students

The contingency table presented in Figure 6 illustrates the distribution of preferred learning modalities among students from the SMIT-ACI and SMIT-LME programs. It reveals clear differences in learning preferences between the two groups. Blended learning was the most preferred modality for both programs, with 29 students from SMIT-ACI and 16 students from SMIT-LME selecting it as their top choice. On the other hand, full face-to-face learning was the least preferred modality, with no students from SMIT-ACI opting for it and only 14 students from SMIT-LME choosing it. Hybrid and online learning modalities showed moderate

preferences. In SMIT-ACI, 20 students preferred hybrid learning, while 12 favored online learning, whereas in SMIT-LME, 8 students preferred hybrid learning and just 1 student selected online learning.

To determine whether there is a significant association between the degree program and the preferred learning modality, a Chi-Square test was conducted. The calculated Chi-Square value was 28.8, with a p-value of less than 0.001. This highly significant result indicates a strong association between the two variables, meaning that the distribution of learning modality preferences varies significantly between SMIT-ACI and SMIT-LME students. These findings suggest that the preferred modes of learning are not uniform across the two programs, with students from each program exhibiting distinct preferences that may reflect the specific needs or characteristics of their academic paths.

Contingency Tables

Contingency Tables					
Year Level	Preferred learning modality				Total
	Blended	Full Face-to-Face	Hybrid	Online	
First Year	6	5	2	3	16
Third Year	23	3	16	4	46
Fourth Year and Above	4	4	6	3	17
Second Year	12	2	4	3	21
Total	45	14	28	13	100

χ^2 Tests			
	Value	df	p
χ^2	14.0	9	0.124
N	100		

Fig. 7. Chi square computation between the preferred learning modality and year level of students

The Chi-Square test was performed to examine if there is a significant relationship between students' year level and their preferred learning modality. The results in Figure 7 showed that the p-value was 0.124, which is greater than the standard significance level of 0.05. This suggests that there is no significant association between the year level of students (whether they are in their first, second, third, or fourth year) and their preferred learning modality (Blended, Full Face-to-Face, Hybrid, or Online). In other words, students from different year levels tend to have similar preferences for learning modalities, and these preferences do not vary substantially based on their academic standing. Therefore, the null hypothesis—that there is no relationship between year level and learning modality preference—could not be rejected.

Frequencies

Frequencies of Preferred learning modality				
Preferred learning modality	Degree Program	Counts	% of Total	Cumulative %
Blended	SMIT-ACI	29	29.0 %	29.0 %
	SMIT-LME	16	16.0 %	45.0 %
Full Face-to-Face	SMIT-ACI	0	0.0 %	45.0 %
	SMIT-LME	14	14.0 %	59.0 %
Hybrid	SMIT-ACI	20	20.0 %	79.0 %
	SMIT-LME	8	8.0 %	87.0 %
Online	SMIT-ACI	12	12.0 %	99.0 %
	SMIT-LME	1	1.0 %	100.0 %

Fig. 8. Frequency distribution between SMIT students and their preferred modality

Figure 8 provides an overview of how students from different degree programs at the School of Management and Information Technology (SMIT) prefer different learning modalities. It shows the number of students who selected each modality (Blended, Full Face-to-Face, Hybrid, or Online), along with the percentage of students in each degree program who prefer

each modality, and the cumulative percentage. This distribution highlights the diversity in learning preferences across degree programs, with some programs showing a higher tendency towards specific modalities. For example, students in certain programs may show a greater preference for face-to-face learning due to the need for in-person interaction or practical components, while others may prefer online or blended formats for flexibility.

The cumulative percentage helps to understand the overall preference trends, showcasing how students in each program tend to favor a particular mix of modalities. These insights can help the university tailor its educational offerings to better align with students' learning preferences within each program.

Frequencies

Frequencies of Preferred learning modality				
Preferred learning modality	Year Level	Counts	% of Total	Cumulative %
Blended	Third Year	23	23.0 %	23.0 %
	Second Year	12	12.0 %	35.0 %
	Fourth Year and Above	4	4.0 %	39.0 %
	First Year	6	6.0 %	45.0 %
Full Face-to-Face	Third Year	3	3.0 %	48.0 %
	Second Year	2	2.0 %	50.0 %
	Fourth Year and Above	4	4.0 %	54.0 %
	First Year	5	5.0 %	59.0 %
Hybrid	Third Year	16	16.0 %	75.0 %
	Second Year	4	4.0 %	79.0 %
	Fourth Year and Above	6	6.0 %	85.0 %
	First Year	2	2.0 %	87.0 %
Online	Third Year	4	4.0 %	91.0 %
	Second Year	3	3.0 %	94.0 %
	Fourth Year and Above	3	3.0 %	97.0 %
	First Year	3	3.0 %	100.0 %

Fig. 9. Frequency distribution between year level and their preferred learning modality

Figure 9 presents the distribution of students' preferred learning modalities across different year levels. The result reveals that Blended Learning is the most preferred modality for students at all year levels, with the highest percentage observed among third-year students (23.0%). This suggests that third-year students are particularly inclined toward a mixed learning approach, likely due to the need for flexibility while balancing academic responsibilities. On the other hand, Full Face-to-Face learning is the least favored modality, with the highest preference (6.0%) coming from first-year students. This could reflect first-year students' desire for more in-person interactions as they transition into university life. Hybrid and Online learning modalities show moderate levels of preference across different year levels, with no significant variation, indicating a steady demand for these more flexible learning formats among students.

Frequencies

Frequencies of Year Level				
Year Level	Degree Program	Counts	% of Total	Cumulative %
Third Year	SMIT-ACI	35	35.0 %	35.0 %
	SMIT-LME	11	11.0 %	46.0 %
Second Year	SMIT-ACI	12	12.0 %	58.0 %
	SMIT-LME	9	9.0 %	67.0 %
Fourth Year and Above	SMIT-ACI	8	8.0 %	75.0 %
	SMIT-LME	9	9.0 %	84.0 %
First Year	SMIT-ACI	6	6.0 %	90.0 %
	SMIT-LME	10	10.0 %	100.0 %

Fig. 10. Frequency distribution between year level and their respective degree program

Figure 10 examines the distribution of students from various year levels across the two degree programs, SMIT-ACI and SMIT-LME. It highlights that the third year is the largest year

level in both programs, with 35 students in SMIT-ACI and 11 students in SMIT-LME. This is followed by the second year, which has a fairly balanced distribution between the two programs, with 12 students in SMIT-ACI and 9 students in SMIT-LME. The fourth year and above category shows a slightly higher proportion of students in SMIT-LME compared to SMIT-ACI, indicating a potential trend where SMIT-LME attracts a slightly larger number of senior students. Finally, first-year students are more numerous in SMIT-LME than in SMIT-ACI, which could reflect specific enrollment patterns or the academic structure of each program.

Conclusion

This study explored the learning modality preferences of SMIT students at De La Salle-College of Saint Benilde, focusing on how logistical challenges and academic factors influence their choices. The findings revealed that Blended Learning was the most preferred modality, followed by Hybrid, while Full Face-to-Face and Online learning were the least favored. This indicates a strong inclination towards flexibility and a balance between online and in-person interaction. The results also highlighted that preferences varied significantly across demographic factors, such as degree programs, with SMIT-ACI students favoring Blended and Hybrid modalities and SMIT-LME students showing a stronger preference for Full Face-to-Face learning.

The analysis of logistical challenges revealed that while these issues impacted learning experiences across all modalities, their influence was not statistically significant in determining modality preferences. However, a weak or marginal relationship was noted, suggesting that students in flexible modalities like Blended and Hybrid may feel these challenges more acutely due to their reliance on balancing both online and in-person components. Year level was found to

have no significant association with learning preferences, indicating consistent trends across different academic standings.

Overall, the study underscores the importance of understanding students' diverse needs and logistical realities when designing learning environments. The findings can help educational institutions like De La Salle-College of Saint Benilde optimize their delivery methods by aligning them with the preferences and challenges of their student population, particularly in urban settings like Metro Manila. Future research could further explore the nuanced impact of specific logistical barriers and extend the study to other academic institutions for a broader perspective.

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Appendices

Survey Form

Learning Modalities in SMIT: Student Preferences for Face-to-Face, Online, Hybrid, or Blended

Demographic Questions

Year Level *

☐ Freshman (First Year)

☐ Sophomore (Second Year)

☐ Junior (Third Year)

☐ Senior (Fourth Year and Above)

Degree Program *

☐ SMIT-LME (Leadership, Management, and Entrepreneurship Cluster)

☐ SMIT-ACI (Analytics, Computing, and Infotech Cluster)

Learning Modality Preferences

What is your preferred learning modality? *

☐ Full Face-to-Face (learning wholly conducted in person)

☐ Online (learning wholly conducted over the internet)

☐ Blended (separate schedules for face-to-face and online meetings)

☐ Hybrid (online and face-to-face classroom discussions happen simultaneously)

Please explain your answer to the previous question. *

Your answer

Please rate how strongly each factor influences your choice of learning modality. *

	Not at all	Slightly	Moderately	Very	Extremely
Commute time	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Access to campus resources and facilities	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Interaction with classmates and faculty	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Flexibility in class schedules	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Personal convenience	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Hands-on learning opportunities	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐
Collaboration with peers	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Engagement and focus	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

To what extent do you feel these logistical challenges impact your learning experience? *

	1	2	3	4	5	
Not at all	☒	☐	☐	☐	☐	Extremely

What are your primary concerns with face-to-face learning? (Select all that apply) *

- ☐ Limited flexibility in class schedules
- ☐ Traffic
- ☐ Cost of commuting or transportation
- ☐ Time management challenges due to travel
- ☐ Interaction with classmates and faculty
- ☐ Crowded classrooms or campus spaces
- ☐ Campus parking availability
- ☐ Distance to the campus
- ☐ Access to campus resources and facilities
- ☐ Other: _____

What are your primary concerns with online or hybrid learning? (Select all that apply) *

- ☐ Lack of in-person interaction
- ☐ Lack of hands-on learning opportunities
- ☐ Difficulty collaborating with peers
- ☐ Difficulty staying engaged or focused
- ☐ Access to faculty support
- ☐ Internet connectivity
- ☐ Technical issues with required software/platforms
- ☐ Limited access to campus resources
- ☐ Other: _____

Open-Ended Feedback

Are there any improvements or changes you would like to see in your preferred learning modality? (Optional)

Your answer

Do you have any additional comments or suggestions regarding learning modalities and their impact on your studies? (Optional)

Your answer

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Raw Data

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